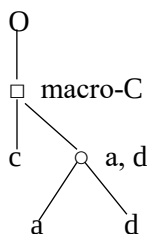


But what about the few places where Koine and Andreas agree against Complutensian; did they do an ‘end-run’ and go back directly to the Original? [How could that be possible?] Did they ‘pick and choose’, consulting an exemplar different from the Complutensian? Such an exemplar would be a node above Koine and Andreas, since they both subsequently went their separate ways. [I suppose that would at least be possible.] But what if Complutensian correctly represents the Original? Then a stemma would perhaps look like this:



I suppose that one’s final choice will be guided by considerations beyond pattern and dependency. But we need pattern and dependency to get us close to a final choice.

Early Uncial Support for f^{35} in the General Epistles

I take it that Klaus Wachtel, in his *Der Byzantinische Text der Katholischen Briefe* [*The Byzantine Text of the Catholic Letters*], recognizes that the Byzantine **text** is early (though often deciding against it on internal grounds), thereby bidding adieu to the prevailing canard that the Byzantine text is late. I believe that the evidence presented below demonstrates the same for the **text** of f^{35} .

I proceed to tabulate the performance of the early uncials (5th century and earlier) as they appear in the apparatus of my Greek text of the seven General Epistles, but supplemented from the *Editio Critica Maior* series.¹ I use f^{35} as the point of reference, but only tabulate variant sets where at least one of the extant early uncials (extant at that point) goes against f^{35} (this is necessary, since most words have unanimous attestation).

Thirteen early uncials appear in my apparatus: P^{20,23,72,78,81,100}, $\aleph$, A, B, C, 048, 0173, 0232. Only P⁷², $\aleph$, A, B, C are not fragments (048 is a

¹ *Editio Critica Maior*, The Institute for New Testament Textual Research, ed (Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1997), vol. IV, Catholic Epistles.